SSC MTS 2024 question paper with answers

5 November 2024 · Shift 2

71 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: 3 marks a question; no negative marking in Session-I (Numerical and Mathematical Ability, Reasoning), 1 mark deducted for each wrong answer in Session-II (General Awareness, English).

The other 19 of the paper's 90 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://ssc.gov.in/api/attachment/uploads/masterData/AnswerKeys/approved_writeup_26425.pdf

Numerical and Mathematical Ability 14 questions

Q.1

Ram borrows a sum of ₹24,000 from his friend Soham on 31December 2021 on the condition that he will return the same after one year with simple interest at 18% per annum. However, Ram is able to return the money on 1August 2022. What amount does Ram have to return to Soham?

(A) ₹25,520
(B) ₹26,250
(C) ₹26,520
(D) ₹25,250

Q.2

Find the simple interest (in ₹) on ₹3000 as a sum borrowed at 9% per year rate of interest for 5 years.

(A) 1310
(B) 1390
(C) 1350
(D) 1290

Q.4

The average weight of 5 persons sitting in a boat is 28 kg. If the average weight of the boat and the persons sitting in the boat is 56 kg, what is the weight of the boat?

(A) 196 kg
(B) 232 kg
(C) 122 kg
(D) 242 kg

Q.6

If the numbers X + 2, X + 5, 2X – 3 and 3X – 5 are in proportion, then which of the following pairs of values is possible for X?

(A) 4 and 2
(B) 5 and 3
(C) 5 and 1
(D) 3 and 2

Q.7

A number is increased by 24% and then decreased by 25%. What is the net increase or decrease percentage?

(A) Decrease 7%
(B) Decrease 8%
(C) Increase 8%
(D) Increase 7%

Q.8

The area (in cm^2) of circle that can be inscribed in a square of side 12 cm is:

(A) 36π
(B) 72π
(C) 24π
(D) 144π

Q.9

Find the simple interest (in ₹) on ₹2500 as a sum borrowed at 8% per year rate of interest for 5 years.

(A) 1040
(B) 1000
(C) 960
(D) 940

Q.10

The average of all the numbers between 8 and 68 that are divisible by 9 is:

(A) 33 **(B)** 40.5

(C) 36 **(D)** 31.5

Q.11

A policeman notices a thief from a distance of 220 m. He chases the thief when he started running the moment he saw the police. The thief and policeman run at the rate of 9 km/h and 11 km/h respectively. How much distance policeman has to cover for catching the thief?

(A) 1.48 km **(B)** 1.21 km

(C) 0.98 km **(D)** 0.86 km

Q.13

What is the difference between the average of prime numbers between 30 and 50 and the average of multiples of 3 between 20 and 50?

(A) 2.6 **(B)** 4.5

(C) 5.3 **(D)** 3.2

Q.15

A and B start running on a circular race track whose length is 3240 m. A and B start from the same point and at the same time, but in opposite directions. If A runs at a speed of 10 m/s and they cross each other 3 minutes after they start running, then what is B's speed (in m/s)?

(A) 9 **(B)** 8

(C) 7.5 **(D)** 8.5

Q.16

The monthly incomes of Selva for 3 months of a year are ₹19,500, ₹21,500 and ₹22,000. What is Selva's average income per month for these 3 months?

(A) ₹21,500 **(B)** ₹21,000

(C) ₹20,500 **(D)** ₹20,000

Q.17

By selling an article for ₹20, a dealer makes a profit of 20%. By how much should he increase his selling price (in ₹, rounded off to two decimal place) so as to make a profit of 30%?

(A) 2.67 **(B)** 3.67

(C) 4.67 **(D)** 1.67

Q.19

The LCM of 16,20 and 24 is:

(A) 240 **(B)** 135

(C) 260 **(D)** 180

Reasoning Ability and Problem Solving 15 questions

Q.1

What will come in the place of '?' in the following equation, if '+' and '–' are interchanged and '×' and '÷' are interchanged? $25 + 20 \times 10 \div 2 - 5 = ?$

(A) 10 **(B)** 26

(C) 39 **(D)** 19

Q.2

U, V, W, X, Y, Z and A are sitting around a circular table facing the centre (but not necessarily in the same order). Only one person sits between Y and X when counted from the left of X. A sits third to the right of U. V sits third to the left of W. A sits to the immediate right of V. Z is not an immediate neighbour of V. How many people sit between Z and X when counted from the right of Z?

(A) Three
(B) Two
(C) Four
(D) One

Q.3

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: Some cameras are radios. All radios are routers. Conclusions: (I): Some cameras are routers. (II): No camera is a router.

(A) Only conclusion (II) follows.
(B) Only conclusion (I) follows.
(C) Neither conclusion (I) nor (II) follows.
(D) Both conclusions (I) and (II) follow.

Q.4

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: Some cameras are phones. No phone is a laptop. Conclusions: (I) Some phones are cameras. (II) Some laptops are phones.

(A) Neither conclusion I nor II follows
(B) Both conclusion I and II follow
(C) Only conclusion II follows
(D) Only conclusion I follows

Q.5

PS 41 is related to KN 47 in a certain way. In the same way, TW 30 is related to OR 36. To which of the following is VY 27 related following the same logic?

(A) LH 33
(B) TQ 33
(C) QT 33
(D) HL 33

Q.6

What will come in place of the question mark (?) in the following equation, if '+' and '–' are interchanged and '×' and '÷' are interchanged? 310 × 2 – 3 ÷ 40 + 170 = ?

(A) 142
(B) 151
(C) 129
(D) 105

Q.7

22 is related to 43 following a certain logic. Following the same logic,35 is related to 69. To which of the following is 81 related, following the same logic? (NOTE : Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into its constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding / subtracting / multiplying, etc., to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed.)

(A) 163
(B) 162
(C) 160
(D) 161

Q.8

In a code language, 'JASMINE' is coded as '213' and 'TULIP' is coded as '234'. How will 'CHAMELI' be coded in the same language?

(A) 153
(B) 143
(C) 157
(D) 148

Q.10

EHJD is related to LOQK in a certain way based on the English alphabetical order. In the same way, GJLF is related to NQSM. To which of the following is ILNH related, following the same logic?

(A) PSUO
(B) SPOU
(C) SPUO
(D) PSOU

Q.12

In a certain code language, 'do it correctly' is written as 'nq sd fo' and 'Please do this' is written as 'rt fo in'. How is 'do' written in the given code language?

(A) nq
(B) fo
(C) rt
(D) sd

Q.13

In a certain code language, 'I Love biryani' is written as 'qs vx pg' and 'biryani was good' is written as 'vx pm ed'. How is 'biryani' written in the given code language?

(A) vx
(B) ed
(C) qs
(D) pm

Q.15

In the following number-pairs, the second number is obtained by applying certain mathematical operations to the first number. Select the set in which the numbers are related in the same way as are the numbers of the following sets. (NOTE: Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into their constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding/subtracting/multiplying to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed.) 10, 49; 14, 69

(A) 18, 88
(B) 17, 89
(C) 17, 88
(D) 18, 89

Q.17

What should come in place of the question mark (?) in the given series? 736, 689, 642, 595, 548 ?

(A) 501
(B) 481
(C) 511
(D) 499

Q.18

What should come in place of the question mark (?) in the given series based on the English alphabetical order? JBM, MEJ, PHG, SKD, ?

(A) VNC
(B) VNA
(C) WNA
(D) WNB

Q.20

In a certain code language, 'POST' is coded as '3854' and 'TIPS' is coded as '5648'. What is the code for 'O' in that language?

(A) 3
(B) 6
(C) 4
(D) 8

General Awareness 18 questions

Q.3
Which volume of the 'Akbar-Nama' is known as Ain-i-Akbari and deals with Akbar's administration, household, army and the revenues and geography of his empire?

(A) Second
(B) Fourth
(C) Fifth
(D) Third

Q.4
In which athletics event did Eldhose Paul win a gold medal at the Commonwealth Games 2022?

(A) Javelin Throw
(B) Triple Jump
(C) Long Jump
(D) Shot Put

Q.5
Which of the following is NOT a private sector industry in India?

(A) Dabur Industries
(B) Bajaj Auto Ltd.
(C) Bharat Heavy Electricals Limited (BHEL)
(D) Tata Iron and Steel Company (TISCO)

Q.6
Who among the following was appointed as the Director of the Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) in May 2023?

(A) Shantanu Roy
(B) Rakesh Asthana
(C) Praveen Sood
(D) Debadatta Chand

Q.7
Brahmo Samaj, the theistic movement within Hinduism, was founded by Raja Ram Mohan Roy in the year _____.

(A) 1856
(B) 1879
(C) 1828
(D) 1839

Q.8
How does salt contribute to the preservation of food?

(A) By reducing the pH of the food.
(B) By inhibiting the growth of microorganisms through osmosis.
(C) By promoting the Maillard reaction.
(D) By acting as an antioxidant.

Q.10
Which of the following is the main objective of the DWCRA model of SHGs?

(A) To provide education opportunities for rural children
(B) To provide self-employment opportunities for rural women
(C) To provide housing support for rural families
(D) To provide healthcare services to rural women

Q.11
The English novel 'Morning Face' is written by:

(A) RK Narayan
(B) Mulk Raj Anand
(C) Anita Desai
(D) Vikram Seth

Q.12
Under Article 165, the Governor appoints a person who is qualified to be appointed a Judge of a High Court to be the _____ for the State.

(A) Chief Minister
(B) Comptroller Auditor General
(C) Attorney General
(D) Advocate-General

Q.14
Which of the following Articles is automatically suspended when an emergency is declared on the grounds of external aggression?

(A) Article 32
(B) Article 22
(C) Article 19
(D) Article 35

Q.15
The 'Mahawat' term is associated with which season in North-West India?

(A) Rainy season
(B) Winter rainfall
(C) Post Monsoons rainfall
(D) Summer rainfall

Q.16
Rita Mustaphi who is honoured with Mcknight Fellowship of 2023 for her excellent innovation in which of the following Indian Dance Forms?

(A) Kathak
(B) Yakshagana
(C) Manipuri
(D) Kathakali

Q.17
Which of the following Census decades in India recorded the highest crude death rate?

(A) 1931-1941
(B) 1991-2001
(C) 1911-1921
(D) 1941-1951

Q.19
Kelucharan Mohapatra is associated with which of the following dances?

(A) Fugdi
(B) Bihu
(C) Odissi
(D) Dumhal

Q.21
Padma Shri Pandit Rajeev Tharanath, the famous _____ player is from the state of Karnataka.

(A) flute
(B) sarod
(C) violin
(D) sitar

Q.23
Which day is celebrated as International Day of Non-Violence?

(A) 31st January
(B) 15th August
(C) 31st October
(D) 2nd October

Q.24
The Anusandhan National Research Foundation Bill, 2023 was introduced in Lok Sabha on 4 August 2023, which repeals the _____.

(A) Science and Engineering Research Board Act, 2008
(B) Science and Engineering Research Board Act, 2006
(C) Science and Engineering Research Board Act, 2009
(D) Science and Engineering Research Board Act, 2007

Q.25
At 1 bar pressure, the volume of a fixed amount of hydrogen gas is 2.27 litre. What will be the volume if the pressure is kept at 0.2 bar?

(A) 11.35 cm^3
(B) 11350 cm^3
(C) 10270 cm^3
(D) 12250 cm^3

English Language and Comprehension 24 questions

Q.2

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Hanging by a thread.

(A) To avoid danger or trouble
(B) To do something very risky
(C) To be perilously close to failing, dying, or resulting in a bad outcome
(D) Crude and lacking sophistication

Q.3

select the most appropriate synonym of the word given in brackets. Despite facing numerous challenges, her [tenacious] determination never faded one bit.

(A) confused
(B) gentle
(C) stubborn
(D) weak

Q.4

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. John's coffee is "hot" than Jack's.

(A) hotter
(B) hottest
(C) most hot
(D) more hotter

Q.5

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. We all _____ at the sky as it was full of stars that night.

(A) Hooked
(B) Packed
(C) Saw
(D) Gazed

Q.6

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined words in the given sentence. After the heavy rains last Thursday, the water in the river "raised another three feet".

(A) will raise another three feet
(B) rose another three feet
(C) risen another three feet
(D) raise another three feet

Q.7

Select the most appropriate synonym of the underlined word. The politician's speech was an attempt to "mitigate" the concerns of the citizens.

(A) Understand
(B) Establish
(C) Aggravate
(D) Lessen

Q.8

Select the word segment that substitutes the bracketed word segment correctly and completes the sentence meaningfully. The movie was (mostly over) when we entered the hall.

(A) almost over
(B) most over
(C) more done
(D) most done

Q.9

The following sentence has been divided into parts. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer. Yesterday, / my surgeon / operate on my knee.

(A) Yesterday
(B) No error
(C) my surgeon
(D) operate on my knee

Q.10

Select the most appropriate synonym of the underlined word. The news of her promotion left her feeling “buoyant”, with a sense of accomplishment and pride in her work.

(A) Peculiar
(B) Dour
(C) Cheerful
(D) Shy

Q.11

Select the option that has an error in the use of present tense.

(A) I have performed all my duties with utmost sincerity.
(B) The mother cooks delicious food for her children.
(C) I am observing your mischievous activities for half an hour.
(D) The painter is painting the wall right now.

Q.12

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) Happiness
(B) Veneration
(C) Indoulgent
(D) Forgotten

Q.13

In the following sentence the underlined part contains as error. Alternatives to the underlined part are given as options. Select the correct alternative. He looked extremely smart and “handsomest” in the black suit.

(A) most handsome
(B) handsomely
(C) handsome
(D) handsomer

Q.14

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blanks. An adventurer packed _____ backpack and _____ assortment of survival gear for the challenging trek through the wilderness.

(A) a; an
(B) a; a
(C) an; an
(D) an; a

Q.15

Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined phrase. Can you please stop “continuously complaining about” the student's shortcomings?

(A) Crying
(B) Jesting
(C) Whining
(D) Grunting

Q.16

Select the option that does NOT contain an adverb.

(A) Rohit loves chocolate.
(B) She ran swiftly to catch the thief.
(C) Maya was quite absent-minded during class today.
(D) He never forgets his homework.

Q.17

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. I need to _____ my shoelaces before going out.

(A) tye
(B) tie
(C) thigh
(D) thai

Q.18

Identify the INCORRECTLY spelt word from the given sentence. Comprehensiveness constitues wisdom and many examples from history illustrate this fact.

(A) Illustrate
(B) Wisdom
(C) Comprehensiveness
(D) Constitues

Q.19

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM to substitute the underlined word in the given sentence. How would you describe your “ideal” vacation destination?

(A) reproving
(B) instant
(C) gloomy
(D) faulty

Q.20

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. To throw caution to the wind

(A) To give answer with utmost attention
(B) To roam here and there aimlessly
(C) To do something with care and attention
(D) To do something without worrying about risk

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. In the realm of literature, metaphors and similes are like (1) _____ tools for writers. They serve to (2) _____ the reader's understanding and make the text more (3) _____. However, it's crucial for writers to (4) _____ use them, as excessive figurative language can (5) _____ the clarity of the writing.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(A) inoperative
(B) concision
(C) indispensable
(D) believable

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. In the realm of literature, metaphors and similes are like (1) _____ tools for writers. They serve to (2) _____ the reader's understanding and make the text more (3) _____. However, it's crucial for writers to (4) _____ use them, as excessive figurative language can (5) _____ the clarity of the writing.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(A) illuminate
(B) flaw
(C) cavitate
(D) abdicate

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. In the realm of literature, metaphors and similes are like (1) _____ tools for writers. They serve to (2) _____ the reader's understanding and make the text more (3) _____. However, it's crucial for writers to (4) _____ use them, as excessive figurative language can (5) _____ the clarity of the writing.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(A) substantiality
(B) vivid
(C) meaning
(D) ambiguity

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. In the realm of literature, metaphors and similes are like (1) _____ tools for writers. They serve to (2) _____ the reader's understanding and make the text more (3) _____. However, it's crucial for writers to (4) _____ use them, as excessive figurative language can (5) _____ the clarity of the writing.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(A) spatially
(B) pathetically
(C) indiscriminately
(D) judiciously

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. In the realm of literature, metaphors and similes are like (1) _____ tools for writers. They serve to (2) _____ the reader's understanding and make the text more (3) _____. However, it's crucial for writers to (4) _____ use them, as excessive figurative language can (5) _____ the clarity of the writing.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(A) enhance
(B) simplify
(C) clarify
(D) detract from

Answer key

Numerical and Mathematical Ability

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(C)**	Q.4 **(A)**	Q.6 **(C)**	Q.7 **(A)**	Q.8 **(A)**
Q.9 **(B)**	Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(B)**	Q.13 **(C)**	Q.15 **(B)**	Q.16 **(B)**
Q.17 **(D)**	Q.19 **(A)**				

Reasoning Ability and Problem Solving

Q.1 **(B)**	Q.2 **(A)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.4 **(D)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.6 **(D)**
Q.7 **(D)**	Q.8 **(A)**	Q.10 **(A)**	Q.12 **(B)**	Q.13 **(A)**	Q.15 **(D)**
Q.17 **(A)**	Q.18 **(B)**	Q.20 **(A)**			

General Awareness

Q.3 **(D)**	Q.4 **(B)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.6 **(C)**	Q.7 **(C)**	Q.8 **(B)**
Q.10 **(B)**	Q.11 **(B)**	Q.12 **(D)**	Q.14 **(C)**	Q.15 **(B)**	Q.16 **(A)**
Q.17 **(C)**	Q.19 **(C)**	Q.21 **(B)**	Q.23 **(D)**	Q.24 **(A)**	Q.25 **(B)**

English Language and Comprehension

Q.2 **(C)**	Q.3 **(C)**	Q.4 **(A)**	Q.5 **(D)**	Q.6 **(B)**	Q.7 **(D)**
Q.8 **(A)**	Q.9 **(D)**	Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(C)**	Q.12 **(C)**	Q.13 **(C)**
Q.14 **(A)**	Q.15 **(C)**	Q.16 **(A)**	Q.17 **(B)**	Q.18 **(D)**	Q.19 **(D)**
Q.20 **(D)**	Q.21 **(C)**	Q.22 **(A)**	Q.23 **(B)**	Q.24 **(D)**	Q.25 **(D)**

Explanations

Numerical and Mathematical Ability

Q.1 · Answer (C) ₹26,520

The loan from 31 December 2021 to 1 August 2022 is taken as 7 months (January to July): SI = 24,000 × 18/100 × 7/12 = ₹2,520, so Ram returns 24,000 + 2,520 = ₹26,520. Counting the exact 213 days (213/365 of a year) gives ₹2,520.99, practically the same.

Q.2 · Answer (C) 1350

SI = 3,000 × 9 × 5/100 = ₹1,350.

Q.4 · Answer (A) 196 kg

The 5 persons weigh 5 × 28 = 140 kg, and the boat and the persons together 6 × 56 = 336 kg, so the boat weighs 336 − 140 = 196 kg.

Q.6 · Answer (C) 5 and 1

$(X + 2)(3X - 5) = (X + 5)(2X - 3)$ gives $3X^2 + X - 10 = 2X^2 + 7X - 15$, so $X^2 - 6X + 5 = 0$ and X = 5 or 1.

Q.7 · Answer (A) Decrease 7%

1.24 × 0.75 = 0.93, so the number falls by 7%.

Q.8 · Answer (A) 36π

The inscribed circle's diameter equals the side, 12 cm, so its radius is 6 cm and its area $\pi \times 6^2 = 36\pi$ cm².

Q.9 · Answer (B) 1000

SI = 2,500 × 8 × 5/100 = ₹1,000.

Q.10 · Answer (C) 36

The multiples of 9 between 8 and 68 are 9, 18, 27, 36, 45, 54 and 63; their average is the middle term, 36.

Q.11 · Answer (B) 1.21 km

The policeman gains 11 − 9 = 2 km/h on the thief, so he closes the 220 m = 0.22 km in 0.11 hour, in which he runs 11 × 0.11 = 1.21 km.

Q.13 · Answer (C) 5.3

The primes between 30 and 50 are 31, 37, 41, 43 and 47, averaging 199/5 = 39.8. The multiples of 3 from 21 to 48 average (21 + 48)/2 = 34.5. 39.8 − 34.5 = 5.3.

Q.15 · Answer (B) 8

Running in opposite directions, they cross when together they have covered one lap: 10 + B = 3,240/180 = 18 m/s, so B runs at 8 m/s.

Q.16 · Answer (B) ₹21,000

(19,500 + 21,500 + 22,000)/3 = 63,000/3 = ₹21,000.

Q.17 · Answer (D) 1.67

The cost price is 20/1.2 = ₹50/3. For a 30% profit the price must be 1.3 × 50/3 = ₹65/3 (₹21.67), so the increase is ₹5/3, about ₹1.67.

Q.19 · Answer (A) 240

$16 = 2^4$, $20 = 2^2 \times 5$ and $24 = 2^3 \times 3$, so the LCM is $2^4 \times 3 \times 5 = 240$.

Reasoning Ability and Problem Solving

Q.1 · Answer (B) 26

After interchanging the signs: 25 − 20 ÷ 10 × 2 + 5 = 25 − 4 + 5 = 26.

Q.2 · Answer (A) Three
Going round to the right from U the order is U, X, V, A, Z, W, Y: A third to U's right with V just to its left, W third to V's right, Z not beside V, and Y two places to X's left. Counting to the right from Z, W, Y and U come before X: three people.

Q.3 · Answer (B) Only conclusion (I) follows.
The cameras that are radios are also routers, so some cameras are routers (I). II contradicts this, so only I follows.

Q.4 · Answer (D) Only conclusion I follows
'Some cameras are phones' converts to 'some phones are cameras', so I follows. 'No phone is a laptop' means no laptop is a phone, so II does not follow.

Q.5 · Answer (C) QT 33
Each letter moves 5 places back and the number rises by 6: PS 41 → KN 47 and TW 30 → OR 36. So VY 27 → QT 33.

Q.6 · Answer (D) 105
After interchanging the signs: 310 ÷ 2 + 3 × 40 − 170 = 155 + 120 − 170 = 105.

Q.7 · Answer (D) 161
The second number is twice the first minus 1: 22 × 2 − 1 = 43 and 35 × 2 − 1 = 69. Likewise 81 × 2 − 1 = 161.

Q.8 · Answer (A) 153
The code is three times the sum of the letters' places in the alphabet: JASMINE = 10 + 1 + 19 + 13 + 9 + 14 + 5 = 71, and 71 × 3 = 213; TULIP = 78, and 78 × 3 = 234. CHAMELI = 3 + 8 + 1 + 13 + 5 + 12 + 9 = 51, and 51 × 3 = 153.

Q.10 · Answer (A) PSUO
Each letter moves 7 places forward: EHJD → LOQK and GJLF → NQSM. So ILNH → PSUO.

Q.12 · Answer (B) fo
'do' is the only word in both sentences and 'fo' the only code in both, so do = fo.

Q.13 · Answer (A) vx
'biryani' is the only word in both sentences and 'vx' the only code in both, so biryani = vx.

Q.15 · Answer (D) 18, 89
The second number is five times the first minus 1: 10 × 5 − 1 = 49 and 14 × 5 − 1 = 69. Likewise 18 × 5 − 1 = 89.

Q.17 · Answer (A) 501
Each term is 47 less than the one before: 548 − 47 = 501.

Q.18 · Answer (B) VNA
The first letters move +3 (J, M, P, S, V), the second +3 (B, E, H, K, N) and the third −3 (M, J, G, D, A): VNA.

Q.20 · Answer (A) 3
P, S and T are in both words, as are 8, 5 and 4 in both codes. The letter left in POST is O and the digit left in its code is 3, so O = 3.

General Awareness

Q.3 · Answer (D) Third
Abul Fazl's 'Akbar-Nama' has three volumes; the third, the Ain-i-Akbari, describes Akbar's administration, household, army, revenues and the geography of his empire.

Q.4 · Answer (B) Triple Jump
Eldhose Paul won the triple jump at the 2022 Commonwealth Games in Birmingham, with India's Abdulla Aboobacker second.

Q.5 · Answer (C) Bharat Heavy Electricals Limited (BHEL)
BHEL is a public sector undertaking owned by the Government of India; Dabur, Bajaj Auto and TISCO (now Tata Steel) are private companies.

Q.6 · Answer (C) Praveen Sood
Praveen Sood, then Karnataka's Director General of Police, was appointed Director of the CBI in May 2023 for a two-year term.

Q.7 · Answer (C) 1828
Raja Ram Mohan Roy founded the Brahmo Sabha in Calcutta in 1828; it later became the Brahmo Samaj.

Q.8 · Answer (B) By inhibiting the growth of microorganisms through osmosis.
Salt draws water out of the food and out of microbial cells by osmosis, so bacteria and moulds cannot grow.

Q.10 · Answer (B) To provide self-employment opportunities for rural women
DWCRA (Development of Women and Children in Rural Areas), begun in 1982 under the IRDP, organised poor rural women into groups for self-employment and income-generating activities.

Q.11 · Answer (B) Mulk Raj Anand
'Morning Face' (1968), an autobiographical novel by Mulk Raj Anand, won the Sahitya Akademi Award in 1971.

Q.12 · Answer (D) Advocate-General
Article 165 provides for the Advocate-General for the State, appointed by the Governor; the Attorney General (Article 76) is the Union's counterpart.

Q.14 · Answer (C) Article 19
Under Article 358 the freedoms of Article 19 are suspended automatically when a national emergency is proclaimed on the ground of war or external aggression, but not of armed rebellion.

Q.15 · Answer (B) Winter rainfall
Mahawat is the winter rain that western disturbances bring to north-west India; it is valuable for the rabi crops.

Q.16 · Answer (A) Kathak
Rita Mustaphi, a disciple of Pandit Birju Maharaj and founder of the Katha Dance Theatre in Minnesota, is a Kathak dancer and choreographer; her 2023 McKnight Fellowship was for choreography.

Q.17 · Answer (C) 1911-1921
The death rate was highest in 1911-1921, the decade of the 1918 influenza pandemic; it is the only census decade in which India's population fell.

Q.19 · Answer (C) Odissi
Guru Kelucharan Mohapatra was a leading Odissi dancer and teacher, central to the dance's revival in the twentieth century.

Q.21 · Answer (B) sarod
Pandit Rajeev Taranath, a disciple of Ustad Ali Akbar Khan, was a sarod player from Karnataka.

Q.23 · Answer (D) 2nd October
The UN observes 2 October, Mahatma Gandhi's birthday, as the International Day of Non-Violence, under a General Assembly resolution of 2007.

Q.24 · Answer (A) Science and Engineering Research Board Act, 2008
The Anusandhan National Research Foundation Bill, 2023 repeals the Science and Engineering Research Board Act, 2008, bringing SERB into the new foundation.

Q.25 · Answer (B) 11350 cm³
By Boyle's law $p_1V_1 = p_2V_2$: $V_2 = 1 \times 2.27/0.2 = 11.35$ litres = 11,350 cm³.

English Language and Comprehension

Q.2 · Answer (C) To be perilously close to failing, dying, or resulting in a bad outcome
To be 'hanging by a thread' is to be in a precarious state, very close to failure or disaster.

Q.3 · Answer (C) stubborn
'Tenacious' means holding firmly to a purpose: persistent, unyielding, 'stubborn'.

Q.4 · Answer (A) hotter
'Than' compares two things, so the comparative is needed: 'hotter than Jack's'. 'More hotter' is a double comparative.

Q.5 · Answer (D) Gazed
To 'gaze' is to look steadily, and it takes 'at': 'We all gazed at the sky'. 'Saw at' is not idiomatic.

Q.6 · Answer (B) rose another three feet
'Rise' (rose, risen) needs no object, while 'raise' does; the simple past fits 'last Thursday': 'the water in the river rose another three feet'.

Q.7 · Answer (D) Lessen
To 'mitigate' is to make less severe: 'lessen'. 'Aggravate' is its opposite.

Q.8 · Answer (A) almost over
'Almost over' means nearly finished; 'mostly' means for the most part and does not fit with 'over' here.

Q.9 · Answer (D) operate on my knee
'Yesterday' calls for the simple past: 'my surgeon operated on my knee'.

Q.10 · Answer (C) Cheerful
'Buoyant' here means cheerful and optimistic. 'Dour' (stern, gloomy) is nearly its opposite.

Q.11 · Answer (C) I am observing your mischievous activities for half an hour.
An action that began in the past and is still going on takes the present perfect continuous: 'I have been observing your mischievous activities for half an hour.'

Q.12 · Answer (C) Indoulgent
The correct spelling is 'indulgent'.

Q.13 · Answer (C) handsome
'Extremely smart and ...' calls for the positive degree, like 'smart': 'smart and handsome'. The superlative 'handsomest' does not fit.

Q.14 · Answer (A) a; an
'Backpack' begins with a consonant sound, so 'a backpack'; 'assortment' begins with a vowel sound, so 'an assortment'.

Q.15 · Answer (C) Whining
To 'whine' is to complain continually in a peevish way.

Q.16 · Answer (A) Rohit loves chocolate.
'Swiftly', 'quite' and 'never' are adverbs; 'Rohit loves chocolate' has only nouns and a verb.

Q.17 · Answer (B) tie
To 'tie' shoelaces is to fasten them; 'tye' is a misspelling, and 'thigh' and 'thai' are other words.

Q.18 · Answer (D) Constitues
The correct spelling is 'constitutes'.

Q.19 · Answer (D) faulty
'Ideal' means perfect; its opposite is 'faulty'.

Q.20 · Answer (D) To do something without worrying about risk
To 'throw caution to the wind' is to act boldly, without worrying about the risk.

Q.21 · Answer (C) indispensable
Metaphors and similes are 'indispensable', that is essential, tools for writers.

Q.22 · Answer (A) illuminate
They 'illuminate', or throw light on, the reader's understanding.

Q.23 · Answer (B) vivid
They make the text more 'vivid'; 'more' needs an adjective here, and 'substantiality', 'meaning' and 'ambiguity' are nouns.

Q.24 · Answer (D) judiciously
As too much figurative language harms clarity, writers must use them 'judiciously', that is with good judgement.

Q.25 · Answer (D) detract from
Excessive figurative language can 'detract from', that is reduce, the clarity of the writing.

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